

Ethylenediamine



What is it?

Ethylenediamine is a chemical used as a stabilizer. It can be found in some personal care products, medications, and some industrial products.

ETHYLENEDIAMINE can also be known as:

- Ethylenediamine dihydro chloride
- Ethylene diamine hydro chloride
- 1,2-diaminoethane dihydro chloride
- 1,2-ethanediamine
- Chlorethamine

Some Possible Uses of ETHYLENEDIAMINE /

Where it might be found:

- Bath and body wipes
- Body creams and lotions
- Eye cream, face cream
- Body wash, facial cleanser
- Concealer, foundation, mascara
- Shampoo, Hairspray, Hair dye
- Sunscreen
- Eye and nose drops
- Aminophylline pills
- Merthiolate tincture

Some industrial uses:

- Antifreeze
- Animal feed supplement
- Asphalt wetting agent
- Bleach activator
- Cooling fluid
- Electrophoretic gel and solution
- Electroplating
- Epoxy resin hardener
- Floor polish remover
- Intermediate in the manufacture of:

- Dye
- Wax and resin
- Anti insect
- Anti fungus
- Manufacture of:
 - Corrosion inhibitors
 - Drugs and emulsifiers
 - Fuel additives
 - Surfactants
- Quencher in ultrasonic baths for cleaning nonprecious metal jewelry
- Printing ink binder
- Rubber stabilizer and accelerator
- Solvent for casein, albumin, shellac, sulfur
- Textile lubricant
- Urethane foam manufacture

Other products that may cross react with ETHYLENEDIAMINE:

- Diethylenetriamine (a.k.a DETA)
- Triethylenetetramine (a.k.a TETA)
- Dipropylenetriamine (a.k.a DPTA)
- Tetraethylenepentamine (a.k.a TEPA)

Some antihistamines and anti nausea medications may contain or cross react with ethylenediamine, such as:

- Aminophylline
- Tripelennamine
- Phenothiazine (e.g. promethazine)
- Piperazines (e.g. cyclizine)
- Pyrilamine (e.g. Midol, Multi Symptom Pamprin, Premsyn, and it is in the decongestant Rynatan)
- Meclizine (e.g. Antivert, Bonine, Dramamine II)
- Hydroxyzine (e.g. Atarax, Vistaril)
- Cetirizine (e.g. Zyrtec)

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- Levocetirizine (e.g. Xyzal)
- Fluphenazine
- Perphenazine
- Prochlorperazine
- Trifluoperazine
- Thiothixene
- Clozapine
- Olanzapine

Ethylenediamine does **NOT** show cross sensitivity to EDTA.

What should I do to avoid ETHYLENEDIAMINE?

Check the ingredient list of each product you use. If no ingredient list is present, go to the store and inspect the original box or package. Some products' ingredient lists are available on the internet at the manufacturer's or store's website.

To find a possible workplace exposure, check the complete ingredient list of each product you encounter. Look for one of the names above. Check the Material Safety Data Sheet (MSDS) as you are able. If you must touch this allergen, wear heavy duty vinyl gloves. If you must come in contact with this allergen at work or as you care for others, wear gloves made of rubber, nitrile, or vinyl.

Tell your hairdresser, barber, nurse, and others involved in your care about this allergy. Avoid using a product that contains this allergen on your skin or hair.

It is also important to tell your medical provider and pharmacist. Check your prescription creams and pills for this ingredient and avoid them if present.

Safe alternatives for some of the medications listed above include:

- Loratadine (e.g. Claritin, Alavert)
- Diphenhydramine (e.g. Benadryl)
- Fexofenadine (e.g. Allegra)
- Cyproheptadine (e.g. Periactin)
- Chlorpheniramine (e.g. Chlor - Trimeton)
- Dimenhydrinate (e.g. Dramamine)
- Doxepin
- Haloperidol
- Risperidone
- Quetiapine

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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